

The Republican.

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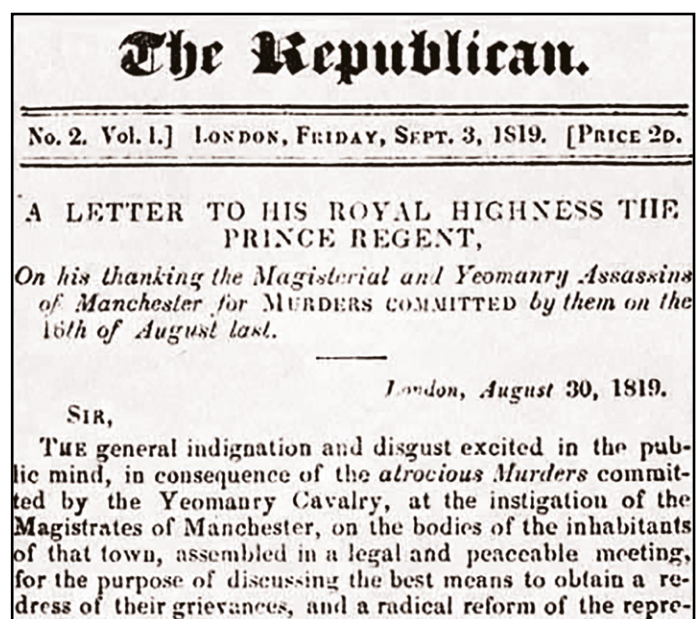
THE HERITAGE of FLEET STREET

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The Republican was a radical British newspaper published from 1819 to 1826 by Richard Carlile. Carlile believed that newspapers could help bring freedom and change society. After the Peterloo Massacre in 1819, in which 18 people were killed during a peaceful protest for political reform, Carlile reported the truth about what had happened and strongly criticised the government.

Because of his articles, Carlile was found guilty of seditious libel and blasphemy. He was sent to prison for six years, but he continued writing for the newspaper while in jail. His wife carried on publishing it until she was also imprisoned.

The government introduced new laws and taxes to stop radical newspapers, making them too expensive for many people to buy. Even so, The Republican became more popular. Many people, including shopkeepers who sold the paper, were arrested, showing how strongly the government tried to silence free speech.



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